

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- The Permanent Threat: Analyzing Aeternum's Blockchain-Based C2 Operations and Communications
- Metabase SQL Zero-Day Attacks Could Have Wide Blast Radius
- OpenAI releases ChatGPT 5.6 Cyber, but it's only for approved users
- Progress LoadMaster bug added to CISA list of exploited vulnerabilities
- The Patch Gap: Why Defenders Need to Think in Chains, Not Checklists

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. The Permanent Threat: Analyzing Aeternum's Blockchain-Based C2 Operations and Communications

Analysis of the Aeternum botnet loader, a threat leveraging Polygon blockchain smart contracts for decentralized C2 infrastructure and payload execution. The post The Permanent Threat: Analyzing Aeternum's Blockchain-Based C2 Operations and Communications appeared first on Unit 42 .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/aeternum-blockchain-c2-analysis/>

02. North Korean spies are running local LLMs to cause AI mischief

Kimsuky's phishing attacks get an AI boost

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/08/10/north-korean-spies-are-running-local-llms-to-cause-ai-mischief/5285632>

03. WordPress Plugins Compromised Without a Single File Change

Poisoned JSON feed let attackers backdoor WordPress sites without changing any plugin files

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/bdthemes-wordpress-poisoned-api/>

04. When Credentials Are No Longer Enough: Device Trust in the AI Era

AI is making phishing, credential theft, and social engineering faster and more efficient, while traditional trust signals such as passwords, MFA, IP reputation, and geolocation become easier to bypass. Specops explains why organizations are increasingly adding device trust to their Zero Trust strategies. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/when-credentials-are-no-longer-enough-device-trust-in-the-ai-era/>

05. Kimsuky Builds Offline AI Stack to Boost Phishing and Automate Malware Development

North Korea's state hackers are no longer content to type prompts into public chatbots. One of the country's main espionage groups has begun running artificial intelligence (AI) offline on its own servers, connecting document-search tools to files in its possession, and collecting the software parts needed to build AI into its malware. South Korean security...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/kimsuky-builds-offline-ai-stack-that.html>

06. Microsoft Entra ID is removing an extra MFA hurdle for Windows Hello and macOS PSSO users

Microsoft is changing how Entra ID handles MFA for people who sign in with Windows Hello for Business (WHfB) or macOS Platform Single Sign-On (PSSO). The rollout reaches worldwide and GCC tenants starting early October 2026, with completion expected by late November. Microsoft says the change “helps organizations expand the use of phishing-resistant authent...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources:

<https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/08/10/entra-id-windows-hello-macos-pssso-standalone-mfa/>

07. Smile, You're on Camera. Part 2: Hiring Lazarus APT's IT Workers in a Fake DeFi Startup

Editor's note: This work is a collaboration between Mauro Eldritch from BCA LTD, a company dedicated to threat intelligence and hunting, Heiner García from NorthScan, a threat intelligence initiative uncovering North Korean IT worker infiltration, and ANY.RUN, the leading company in malware analysis and threat intelligence. The article was written by Mauro...

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Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://any.run/cybersecurity-blog/lazarus-group-it-workers-investigation-part-two/>

08. New Passkey Attacks Can Recover Synced Private Keys or Bypass Phishing-Resistant MFA

Three separate research efforts last week demonstrated ways to defeat passkey protections without breaking the cryptography they rest on. Passkeys are designed to replace reusable passwords and resist phishing. The attacks instead reused signed

authentication material that Windows had exposed, abused a cloud-synced passkey system from malware already on the...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/new-passkey-attacks-can-recover-synced.html>

09. IT threat evolution in Q2 2026. Non-mobile statistics

The report presents key trends and statistics on malware that targeted personal computers running Windows and macOS, as well as internet of things (IoT) devices, during Q2 2026.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://securelist.com/malware-report-q2-2026-pc-iot-statistics/120960/>

10. Go-Based macOS Malware Steals Crypto and Secrets

A macOS malware variant has been detected stealing crypto, passwords and more

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/gobased-macos-malware-crypto-and/>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. Metabase SQL Zero-Day Attacks Could Have Wide Blast Radius

The maximum-severity vulnerability, which still has no CVE, allows malicious, remote administrator access to the business-analytics platform and its downstream users.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.darkreading.com/vulnerabilities-threats/metabase-sql-zero-day-attacks-wide-blast-radius>

02. OpenAI releases ChatGPT 5.6 Cyber, but it's only for approved users

OpenAI has developed a new model called "GPT 5.6 Cyber," designed for vulnerability research, penetration testing, incident response, and remediation. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/openai-releases-chatgpt-56-cyber-but-its-only-for-approved-users/>

03. Progress LoadMaster bug added to CISA list of exploited vulnerabilities

CISA warns of active Progress LoadMaster attacks; patch and investigate now.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/news/progress-loadmaster-bug-added-to-cisa-list-of-exploited-vulnerabilities>

04. The Patch Gap: Why Defenders Need to Think in Chains, Not Checklists

It's time to turn from CVSS-backed patching to choke-point patching focused on breaking chains to critical assets.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.darkreading.com/cybersecurity-operations/patch-gap-defenders-chains-not-checklists>

05. Coruna, DarkSword iOS Exploits Proliferate Globally

Sophisticated iPhone exploit chains previously limited to nation-states are spreading far and wide to organized cybercrime groups.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.darkreading.com/vulnerabilities-threats/coruna-darksword-ios-exploits-proliferate-globally>

06. Researchers Uncover RovoBlast Vulnerability in Atlassian AI Assistant

Atlassian fixed a flaw letting one crafted link make its Rovo AI assistant exfiltrate company data

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/rovoblast-atlassian-rovo-url/>

07. ⚡ Weekly Recap: AI Goes Rogue, Metabase 0-Day, MCP Supply-Chain Attacks, and Router Backdoors

A lot of security problems still begin with someone doing a completely normal thing. Cloning a repo. Answering a call. Leaving a box exposed. Trusting the default. That pretty much covers the mood this week. Old bugs are back, supply chains are getting stranger, and some exploit paths are so short you wonder what was supposed to stop them in the first place...

Why it matters: Publicly discussed 0-days often see rapid weaponization, increasing the risk of opportunistic attacks at scale.

Recommendation: Apply vendor guidance immediately, reduce attack surface, and monitor for IoCs/exploitation telemetry until patches are fully deployed.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/weekly-recap-ai-goes-rogue-metabase-0.html>

08. VU#614868: Opencart ecommerce platform contains directory traversal vulnerability

Overview The OpenCart v4.2.0.0 extension installer contains a directory traversal vulnerability. The extension installation process extracts uploaded...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://kb.cert.org/vuls/id/614868>

09. CISA: SonicWall SMA1000 flaws now exploited by ransomware gangs

CISA has confirmed that ransomware gangs have begun exploiting two recently patched SonicWall SMA1000 vulnerabilities, including a maximum-severity server-side request forgery (SSRF) flaw. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/cisa-sonicwall-sma1000-flaws-now-exploited-by-ransomware-gangs/>

10. Cisco Warns of High-Severity ClamAV Vulnerabilities With Public PoC

Remote, unauthenticated attackers could exploit the bugs to cause a denial-of-service (DoS) condition. The post Cisco Warns of High-Severity ClamAV Vulnerabilities With Public PoC appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.securityweek.com/cisco-warns-of-high-severity-clamav-vulnerabilities-with-public-poc/>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. New StormEncryptor ransomware used by former Medusa affiliate

A financially motivated threat actor previously associated with the Medusa ransomware operation is now deploying a new ransomware strain called StormEncryptor. [...]

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/new-stormencryptor-ransomware-used-by-former-medusa-affiliate/>

02. China-Linked Hackers Deploy New StormEncryptor Ransomware, Likely via N-central Flaw

Microsoft has disclosed that Storm-1175, a financially motivated threat actor linked to China, has deployed a previously undocumented ransomware strain called StormEncryptor. The use of StormEncryptor marks a shift from the adversary's previous use of Medusa ransomware, the Microsoft Threat Intelligence Team said. "StormEncryptor is written in C++ and appen...

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/china-linked-hackers-deploy-new.html>

03. Outdated Cybercrime Laws Put Security Researchers at Risk

A public policy expert mapped global cybercrime laws to develop a five-point framework for protecting ethical hackers and good-faith security research.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.darkreading.com/application-security/outdated-cybercrime-laws-security-researchers-risk>

04. New turnkey kit makes it easy for anyone to become a scammer

We discovered a kit that gave us an insight into how modern online scams are built, promoted, and potentially used to target everyday consumers.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/scams/2026/08/new-turnkey-kit-makes-it-easy-for-anyone-to-become-a-scammer>

05. Talk to the LLM: How AI exposes 'pig butchering' scams

A security researcher is using AI to study and expose long-duration scams that abuse online trust.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/news/talk-to-the-llm-how-ai-exposes-pig-butchering-scams>

06. DeadLock ransomware: Breaking down a Rust-based encryptor with decentralized recovery infrastructure

Microsoft Threat Intelligence examines DeadLock ransomware, an emerging financially motivated operation distinguished by its use of decentralized infrastructure to support victim communications, negotiations, and data leak operations alongside double extortion tactics used to pressure victims. The post DeadLock ransomware: Breaking down a Rust-based encrypt...

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2026/08/10/deadlock-ransomware-breaking-down-a-rust-based-encryptor-with-decentralized-recovery-infrastructure/>

07. Cyberattack on Steam hardware shipper leaks names, addresses, and order data

Video game publisher Valve is alerting customers in Europe to a data breach at CEVA Logistics, its Steam hardware shipping partner. Reports from affected customers began surfacing on social media earlier today, after Valve started sending out data breach notification emails. "Between July 29 2026 and August 1, 2026, a cyberattack hit CEVA Logistics, the com...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/08/10/valve-data-breach-ceva-logistics-steam-hardware/>

08. Member of The Com sent to prison for blackmail, sextortion

A member of "The Com," a loose-knit online cybercrime collective that targets children and teenagers, has been sentenced to two years in prison for blackmail and sextortion offenses against nearly 120 victims worldwide. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/member-of-the-com-sent-to-prison-for-black-mail-sextortion/>

09. One-click flaw in Atlassian Rovo exposed enterprise data via prompt injection attack

Atlassian's enterprise AI assistant Rovo, which is usually connected across sensitive work environments like Slack, Microsoft 365, and Google Workspace, was found vulnerable to data leaks through malicious instructions. At DEF CON 34, researchers from Varonis demonstrated an attack that used Rovo's rovoChatPrompt parameter to place attacker-controlled inst...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4207306/one-click-flaw-in-atlassian-rovo-exposed-enterprise-data-via-prompt-injection-attack.html>

10. Valve notifies Steam hardware customers of a data breach

Video game publisher and digital distribution giant Valve is notifying Steam hardware customers in Europe that hackers stole their data after hacking its shipping partner, CEVA Logistics. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/valve-notifies-steam-hardware-customers-of-a-data-breach/>